had a bold target of an outcome in thirteen years, in reality, it took thirty years and 45 billion Euros, and the fish were back.

After this, the Rhine Action Plan was reformulated as the more ambitious goal, over a ten-year horizon, that the riverine ecosystem would become a thriving environment for all creatures. [1]

Building a bridge vs building institutions

Policymakers in India now understand how to build a bridge. They know that building a bridge is expensive, that it requires professionals to build, that there will be a project plan, that many steps have to be undertaken, and these take time, and only then can a bridge be inaugurated.

The same approach is required with state capacity! When a new government organization is required: (a) It will be expensive; (b) It requires professionals to build it; (c) There must be a formal project plan in order to build the organization and its capabilities; and (d) Implementing this project plan will take time. Only when the project is completed, can a new organization be declared open for business.

We have repeatedly seen new organizations being launched in the Indian state in a casual and informal way. The present ways—of hiring a few people and declaring a government agency open for business within a very short time horizon—are downright harmful. Right at the outset, the organization is crushed with demands that it is ill-prepared for. The fledgling organization is underfunded and under-resourced in every possible way. It gets into a firefighting mindset, makes mistakes, and generally never recovers from the early failures.

We in India have learned how infrastructure projects require time and money. We need to carry this professional approach into building state capacity in government organizations. [2]

The equity market reform started at the G.S. Patel Committee report in 1984. A humble researcher in this team, R.H. Patil, was central to the establishment of NSE. SEBI was begun as a non-statutory organization in